Jar Growth Intern Assignment, Q2: App Exploration and Growth Analysis

Prepared 10 October 2026. All sources accessed on 10 October 2026 unless a date is given. Amounts in ₹ (1 lakh = 1,00,000; 1 crore = 1,00,00,000).

Evidence labels. Fact = sourced and linked. Observation = what Jar's own pages and store listings show. Interpretation / hypothesis / assessment = my reasoning or estimate, not proven. Public reviews are anecdotal, not representative. Reddit threads could not be retrieved with the research tools available, so user feedback here comes from Google Play and App Store reviews only.

My approach

I looked at Jar's main journeys: saving, UPI AutoPay, rewards, withdrawal and jewellery. I also went through Jar's website, its Google Play and App Store listings, and a small sample of public user reviews. I used company and press sources for facts, and the listings and reviews for what users and Jar's own pages say. Where I interpret or estimate, I say so, and I treat the reviews as individual accounts rather than proof of how all users feel.

A. Product and growth context

- **What Jar offers:** Savings in 24K digital gold through UPI AutoPay plans (Daily from ₹10, Weekly from ₹50, Monthly from ₹100), Instant saving of any amount, reward mechanics (Spin to Win, Weekly Magic, Refer & Earn, Coupons) and jewellery through Nek (Jar website, Daily Saving page). The Google Play listing also lists personal loans (selected users), health insurance and UPI payments; I treat these as availability-dependent.
- **Problem solved:** Many Indians lack a savings habit and a simple, trusted first product. Jar pairs a familiar asset (gold) with automation and tiny amounts. The CEO reports about 60% of users in tier-2/3 towns and over 95% saving formally for the first time (TechCrunch, 18 Sep 2025; company-reported).
- **Why product experience matters for growth:** Three things stood out to me. (1) Tickets are small. UPI digital gold averaged about ₹125 per transaction in March 2026 (my calculation, see table), so value comes from repeat habit, not big baskets. (2) The CEO has said revenue comes from the gap between wholesale and retail gold prices (Business Standard, 6 Nov 2024), so pricing trust is part of the product. (3) SEBI cautioned in November 2025 that digital gold is outside its framework (SEBI, 8 Nov 2025), and UPI digital gold value reportedly fell from about ₹2,290 crore in October 2025 to about ₹1,200 crore in November (Angel One, 6 Feb 2026). My reading is that the category reacts to trust shocks.

Metric	Figure and period	What it measures (and does not)	Source
Registered users	35 million across 12,000 pincodes; over 95% first-time formal	Cumulative sign-ups since launch. Not active	TechCrunch; Business Standard, 19 Sep 2025

Metric	Figure and period	What it measures (and does not)	Source
	savers (company statement, Sep 2025)	users or paying customers.	
Store presence	Google Play: 50M+ downloads, 4.7 stars, about 2.03 million reviews (listing updated 23 Sep 2026). App Store: 4.7 from 114k ratings.	Installs and ratings, not users.	Play; App Store, 10 Oct 2026
FY25 revenue	Operating revenue ₹208 crore; total revenue about ₹2,450 crore; net loss excluding ESOP costs about ₹35.23 crore (year to March 2025)	Operating revenue is core income. Total revenue includes the gross value of gold sold, because Jar now acts as principal.	YourStory; Business Standard, 19 Sep 2025
Profitability	Company says profitable in Jan to Mar and Apr to Jun 2025 (June unaudited)	Company-stated quarterly result. Full FY25 was still a loss excluding ESOP.	Business Standard, 19 Sep 2025
Category size (UPI digital gold, NPCI data)	₹3,926 crore and 219 million transactions in Jan 2026 (about 4x Jan 2025's ₹762 crore); 254.4 million transactions and ₹3,172 crore in Mar 2026. Average ticket about ₹125 (₹3,171.96 crore ÷ 254.44 million, my calculation).	Industry-wide purchases via UPI, not Jar-specific.	Angel One, 6 Feb 2026; Angel One, 20 Apr 2026

Data cautions. Not public, and therefore not estimated here: active users, retention, conversion, revenue per user, acquisition cost, churn and margins.

- Revenue labelling: Reported FY25 revenue figures vary in how sources describe operating revenue versus total revenue. I therefore use the ₹208 crore operating-revenue figure for business comparisons and treat the ₹2,450 crore figure as gross gold sales rather than earnings.
- The ₹2,450 crore figure is gross gold sales. It should not be read as earnings or compared with FY24.

- User counts differ across Jar's own pages (35 million in Sep 2025; "4 Cr+" and "5 Crore+" on the website and store pages). I use only the dated, attributed figure.

B. Five effective and user-friendly features

1. A very low entry point with a choice of savings rhythm

What I observed. Daily saving starts at ₹10, weekly at ₹50, monthly at ₹100, and Instant saving accepts any amount (Jar website). Sign-up needs a phone number and a UPI app; Jar advertises a 45-second start.

Why I think it works (interpretation). "I don't have enough to start" stops being a barrier, and the cadence choice mirrors how people are paid (daily earners versus salaried users).

Evidence. The CEO says users invest about 22 times a month in tickets of ₹10 to ₹5,000 (Business Standard, 6 Nov 2024; company-reported). Across the category the average UPI digital gold ticket was about ₹125 in March 2026, so small tickets are the norm.

What it means for growth. A low entry point lowers activation cost and creates many touchpoints per user each month, which is the raw material for habit formation. Because each ₹10 to ₹50 purchase earns little, frequency and retention have to make the economics work, not ticket size. Jar's per-user economics are not public, so I would not go further than that.

2. UPI AutoPay: set it once, then saving happens

What I observed. Setup asks the user to approve an AutoPay mandate from PhonePe, Google Pay or Paytm, after which purchases run automatically (App Store listing). The CEO calls daily savings the "hero feature" (TechCrunch).

Why I think it works (interpretation). It removes the daily decision to save, and the amounts are small enough not to disturb cash flow.

Evidence. TechCrunch reports that sources link AutoPay to repeat transactions. A 60 Decibels survey cited by Jar found 82% reported improved ability to grow savings and 73% better ability to reach financial goals (Business Standard, 19 Sep 2025). Sample size and sponsor were not stated, so I treat it as self-reported.

What it means for growth. I see this as one of Jar's stronger potential retention mechanisms, because recurring flows need no user effort. I would not conclude that from the CEO's comment and a self-reported survey alone. The number I would want is the share of AutoPay users still active at day 30 and day 90, and it is not public.

3. Minimal-step, multilingual onboarding for first-time savers

What I observed. An account needs a phone number and UPI. The App Store listing says KYC is not required to buy gold, and the app is offered in English plus seven Indian languages (TechCrunch says nine; I could not reconcile this).

Why I think it works (interpretation). Few documents and local-language screens reduce intimidation for people who have never used a formal savings product.

Evidence. Company-reported: about 60% of users from tier-2/3 towns, over 95% first-time formal savers, 12,000 pincodes (TechCrunch, 18 Sep 2025).

What it means for growth. This could lift sign-up-to-first-saving conversion in low-documentation segments and make word of mouth easier, which matters for reach beyond metros. One caveat: Jar's website describes setting up KYC with a PAN, so requirements may vary by amount or user, and I would verify in the app. Thin onboarding also raises the stakes for later clarity (Improvements 1 and 2).

4. A bridge from digital gold to physical gold and jewellery

What I observed. The website offers jewellery through Nek (shopnek.com) with home delivery, and the app description says gold can be cashed out or delivered. The Play listing names the jewellery brand "VIBA by Jar" (5,000+ designs), while the website and App Store show Nek. I did not confirm which is current in-app.

Why I think it works (interpretation). Many savers treat gold as a step toward ornaments. The CEO describes users saving to rebuy jewellery pledged in emergencies (Business Standard, 6 Nov 2024). This gives saving a tangible purpose beyond price gains.

Evidence. Company-reported: Nek launched in 2024, uses a drop-ship model with no inventory, serves 8,000+ pincodes and crossed ₹100 crore (₹1 billion) in annual revenue in the prior year (TechCrunch, 18 Sep 2025).

What it means for growth. It offers a path from small recurring balances to larger purchases. But revenue is not margin, and Nek's profitability is not public. Not every saver wants jewellery, so I would treat it as a segment opportunity (Section D), not a default.

5. Visible trust and anti-fraud signals

What I observed. The website names Brink's (vaulting), Vistra (trustee conducting audits), ICICI Lombard (insurance) and daily reconciliation. A top banner states that Jar never asks for OTPs, KYC or payments by call or WhatsApp and gives a fraud-reporting email (Jar website).

Why I think it works (interpretation). Because digital gold is outside the SEBI securities-market framework, named custodians and fraud warnings give first-time users something concrete to check and protect them from impersonators.

Evidence. Jar website, 10 Oct 2026. Context: SEBI says digital gold sits outside its framework (SEBI, 8 Nov 2025), and a survey cited in the World Gold Council's report found 78% of consumers have medium or high trust in digital gold (Outlook Money, 7 Aug 2026).

What it means for growth. Trust cues could support conversion and referrals. But these are company claims and I could not verify the audits or insurance terms. The Play listing names SafeGold's operator as the digital gold partner, while TechCrunch describes an in-house stack with Brink's custody. I would want Jar to make who holds the gold unambiguous (Improvement 2).

C. Five areas for improvement

The complaints below come from a small sample of public reviews and are anecdotal. Where I calculate, the numbers are illustrative and use only the charges Jar discloses.

1. Show the true cost of exit before every purchase and withdrawal

What I noticed. Jar discloses 3% GST on purchase and a 2% to 3% buy-sell spread in its Play listing description, yet a small sample of public reviews describes discovering the cost only at withdrawal. A first-time saver sees a balance of ₹20,000 and receives less.

Evidence. One Google Play reviewer (12 Sep 2026) paid about ₹20,100 over roughly ten months and received ₹19,100; another (4 Sep 2026) reports a similar shortfall after ten months; an App Store reviewer (year not shown) reports ₹14,000 becoming about ₹13,000. My arithmetic at a flat gold price: GST of about ₹585 on ₹20,100, plus a spread of about ₹390 to ₹585, gives roughly ₹975 to ₹1,170, close to what was reported. My read is that this points to an expectation gap rather than a malfunction, though I cannot see the reviewer's price path and would not conclude more from a few reviews. Break-even: gold must rise about 5.1% to 6.2% before withdrawal equals deposits (assumes GST once on purchase and the stated spread). A separate 2024 App Store review says a jewellery item showed ₹0 while ₹1,389 was taken from savings and the order could not be cancelled; it may be a display glitch.

What I would do. My priority would be to show the cost at the moments it matters: (a) on the confirm screen, "You pay ₹100: ₹97.09 gold plus ₹2.91 GST" (Jar already uses this example in its listing); (b) next to the balance, "If you withdrew now you would receive ₹X"; (c) a one-time break-even explainer in week one; (d) a savings calculator net of GST and spread, since the Daily Saving page projects about 11% a year from past gold returns and, in the text I reviewed, does not mention these costs; (e) the exact debit and cancellation terms before a jewellery order is confirmed. This is aimed at new and low-balance savers in their first 90 days, and anyone about to withdraw.

Impact, measurement and priority. I would expect fewer charge disputes and one-star reviews, better informed holding decisions and stronger trust in a category SEBI has flagged. The trade-off is that the CEO ties revenue to the wholesale-retail gap, so clearer disclosure could lower short-term conversion. I would test it with a holdout group instead of assuming. I would measure the share of withdrawals followed by a charge-related contact (down) and 90-day retention of new AutoPay savers (up). My assessment is Low to Medium effort, since the amounts are already computed at purchase and sale and the work is UI, copy and calculator logic. I rank it High priority: the theme recurs in my small, non-random review sample, effort is low and it protects pricing trust.

2. A plain-language card: how your gold is held and what is (not) regulated

What I noticed. SEBI said in November 2025 that digital gold is neither a security nor a commodity derivative and that securities-market investor protections do not apply. In a Monitor Deloitte survey cited by the World Gold Council, 62% of consumers wrongly believed digital gold is regulated while 78% reported medium or high trust. The Play listing text I reviewed discloses GST and spread, but I found no plain statement of regulatory status (in-app disclosure not checked). Who holds the gold also looks inconsistent across Jar's materials (see Feature 5).

Evidence. SEBI press release 70/2025, 8 Nov 2025 (wording as reported by IANS, 8 Nov 2025); Outlook Money, 7 Aug 2026 on the WGC report launched 4 Aug 2026 (WGC); UPI digital gold value dropped after the caution (Angel One, 6 Feb 2026); the government is reportedly considering rules including full physical backing, at discussion stage only (Outlook Money, 28 Sep 2026).

What I would do. I would start with one short screen, "How your gold is held", shown at first purchase and linked from the home and withdrawal screens: who vaults the gold, who audits it, what the insurance covers, one plain sentence that digital gold is not SEBI-regulated, how to complain (Jar already publishes a grievance officer) and what happens at withdrawal. Five lines, in regional languages, no alarmist wording. I would show it again when a balance crosses a threshold such as ₹5,000. It is aimed at first-time savers and users with growing balances.

Impact, measurement and priority. My hypothesis is that informed users are less likely to withdraw in panic after negative news, and Jar would be ahead of likely disclosure rules. The risk is slight friction at first purchase, so I would A/B test it. I would measure comprehension with a one-question in-app check, and withdrawals in the 7 days after major regulatory news versus baseline. My assessment is Low effort: it is content plus one screen, with legal review the main dependency. I rank it High priority because it is cheap and speaks to what I see as a major category-level trust risk at a time of regulatory change.

3. Make withdrawal availability and timing explicit

What I noticed. Jar says there is no lock-in but allows withdrawal 24 hours after a purchase (App Store listing), while the website stresses instant withdrawals. A small sample of reviewers describes a mostly locked balance and a block after withdrawing. I cannot tell whether these reflect designed rules, settlement timing or defects. What stood out to me is that the cost is highest when a saver urgently needs money; the CEO cites family emergencies as a use case.

Evidence. App Store reviews (accessed 10 Oct 2026): one says most of the balance was locked for 24 hours with only a small amount instantly available; another says withdrawal was blocked for 49 hours after a withdrawal. Both are single, unverified accounts, so I would not treat them as a pattern without more data.

What I would do. On the withdrawal screen, I would split the balance into "Available now ₹X" and "Available from [time] ₹Y", with the reason and the expected bank-credit time. I would repeat it in the savings summary and send a notification when locked money becomes available. This is aimed at savers using Jar as an emergency fund, and users who top up with Instant saving and withdraw soon after.

Impact, measurement and priority. I would expect fewer expectation-gap contacts and poor reviews, and my hypothesis is that savers who trust the exit are more likely to keep balances. I would measure withdrawal-related contacts per 1,000 withdrawals and the share of withdrawals credited within the stated window. My assessment is Medium effort: mostly front-end if ledger states exist, more if settlement states must be exposed. I rank it High priority because it is the highest-stakes moment for a saver and the effort is moderate.

4. AutoPay controls built for irregular incomes

What I noticed. Jar's users include daily-wage and small-business earners (TechCrunch) with uneven cash flow, yet one reviewer shows low confidence in control: they report ₹20 debited after pausing AutoPay inside Jar and having to cancel the mandate in PhonePe. Jar's own FAQ (undated) says deductions continue after uninstalling unless the plan is switched off. I also think reward prompts (spins, referrals) should never push savers beyond what they can afford.

Evidence. App Store reviews (single account, unverified); Jar FAQ; TechCrunch on AutoPay's role in repeat transactions. The evidence here is thinner than for Improvements 1 to 3.

What I would do. I would test "Skip today", "Pause 7 days" and "Lean month" (halve the amount) buttons; after a failed debit, offer a lower amount instead of silent retries; show mandate status and the next debit date on the home screen; add one "Stop all deductions" flow that explains or deep-links mandate cancellation in the UPI app; run a weekly "Is ₹X still comfortable?" check; and avoid upsizing nudges for users with recent failed debits. The target is irregular-income savers and users in their first 30 days.

Impact, measurement and priority. This could turn involuntary churn (failed or cancelled mandates) into reduced-amount continuity and cut disputes. I would measure day-90 AutoPay mandate survival and the share of paused users who resume within 14 days. My assessment is Medium effort, since mandate controls are partly constrained by UPI apps and NPCI rules. I rank it Medium priority: the retention upside looks large, but the evidence is thinner and feasibility depends on UPI constraints.

5. A support process users can track, starting with the five most common issues

What I noticed. In the reviews I read, complaints cluster where money moves: deductions, withdrawals, AutoPay, referral rewards and order cancellation. Public replies on Google Play to three different complaints (10 Jul, 4 Sep and 12 Sep 2026) used the same template asking for details by email or WhatsApp. Phone support runs Monday to Friday, 10 AM to 6 PM; WhatsApp is stated as 24/7 (Jar website). Because digital gold sits outside the SEBI securities-market framework, Jar's own grievance process becomes especially important for user confidence.

Evidence. Google Play reviews and replies; an App Store reviewer (2 Nov 2025) says referral rewards stayed unresolved after two tickets. Anecdotal.

What I would do. I would start with a "My issues" tracker showing status and promised response time, with transaction context attached automatically; self-serve answers for the top five issue types that use the user's own numbers (for example, "₹585 of your ₹20,100 was GST"); and evening and weekend human handoff on WhatsApp. It is aimed at savers with a money-moving complaint, and referrers waiting for rewards.

Impact, measurement and priority. I would expect lower cost to serve, fewer public escalations and a more protected referral loop. I would measure first-contact resolution rate and median time to resolution. My assessment is Medium to High effort, so I would start with the top five issue types, not full coverage. I rank it Medium priority: it is the largest effort, and Improvements 1 to 3 should reduce ticket volume at the source first.

D. Revenue and business growth implications

- **Activation (Improvements 1, 2):** Clear costs and risks at first purchase could reduce regret-driven exits later. The effect on first-purchase conversion could be positive or negative, so I would run it as a holdout test.
- **Retention (3, 4):** Predictable exits and controllable AutoPay could turn "pause" into pause rather than uninstall. Mandate survival is the leading indicator I would watch, because tickets are small.

- **Cost to serve (1, 3, 5):** I would test whether these reduce repeat contacts about charges and withdrawal timing, with answers drawn from the user's own transactions.
- **Trust and referrals (1, 2, 5):** Refer & Earn is a visible growth lever on Jar's site; unresolved reward or charge disputes in public reviews work against it.
- **Cross-sell, with guardrails:** I see jewellery as the most credible adjacent line because it spends gold users have already saved. These are segment hypotheses, not validated: gifting (small silver or gold pieces), everyday wear, weddings (long horizon, larger ticket) and milestones such as a birth or graduation. For an MVP, I would let savers set an optional goal, show progress in grams and ₹, and show exactly what leaves the gold balance before they confirm. I would track goal-to-purchase conversion, cancellation and return rates, and post-purchase satisfaction. I would avoid pitching loans or insurance at withdrawal moments, when a saver may be under financial stress.
- **Profit versus volume:** The ₹2,450 crore total revenue is gross gold sales, so volume is not profit. Because revenue is linked to the wholesale-retail gap, I would measure success by contribution per active saver after support cost and returns, not purchase value.

Illustrative measurement framework: how I would size the levers

The table below is a way to decide which levers to test first. Every input is my own assumption. None of it is Jar data, and none of it is a prediction of Jar's actual performance. The cohort is 100,000 new savers on AutoPay at ₹30 a day (₹10,950 a year), and the take rates are placeholders.

Lever	Assumed inputs	Result
Retention (Improvements 3, 4)	Day-90 mandate survival rises from 50% to 54% (assumed +4 points). Each retained saver continues for 12 months.	4,000 more retained savers; ₹4.38 crore more annual gold purchases (4,000 × ₹10,950). At an assumed 0.5%, 1% or 2% contribution: ₹2.19 lakh, ₹4.38 lakh or ₹8.76 lakh a year.
Activation (Improvements 1, 2)	First-saving conversion rises from 30% to 33% (assumed +3 points) among 100,000 sign-ups; 50% of those stay on AutoPay for a year.	3,000 more first savers; 1,500 retained; ₹1.64 crore more annual purchases (1,500 × ₹10,950).
Cost to serve (Improvements 1, 3, 5)	100,000 active savers; 4% contact support each quarter about charges or withdrawals; the changes cut these contacts by 25%; assumed cost ₹50 per contact.	1,000 fewer contacts; ₹50,000 saved a quarter.

How I read it. At small take rates the gain per cohort is modest. My reasoning is that value would come from scale (35 million registered users) and compounding retention. The framework shows which levers to test first; it is not a forecast.

E. Prioritized recommendations

Rank (priority)	Improvement	Customer problem addressed	Expected business value	Primary KPI	Why it ranks here
1 (High)	Show the true cost of exit before buying and withdrawing	Surprise at deductions of about ₹1,000 on ₹20,000 saved	Fewer charge disputes; better trust and 90-day retention	Charge-related contacts per 1,000 withdrawals	Low effort, recurring in reviews, protects pricing trust
2 (High)	Plain-language card on how gold is held and what is regulated	Mistaken belief that digital gold is regulated; unclear custody	Trust that holds up as rules change; fewer panic exits	Comprehension score; withdrawals in 7 days after regulatory news	Low effort and timely given SEBI's caution and proposed rules
3 (High)	Availability-aware withdrawal screen	Uncertainty when money is needed urgently	Fewer expectation-gap contacts and poor reviews	Withdrawal contacts per 1,000 withdrawals	Highest-stakes moment; moderate effort
4 (Medium)	AutoPay controls for irregular incomes	Low confidence in pausing or stopping; failed mandates	Higher mandate survival	Day-90 mandate survival	Strong retention link; limited by UPI constraints
5 (Medium)	Trackable support for the top five issues	Template replies; unresolved tickets	Lower cost to serve; protects referrals	First-contact resolution rate	Largest effort; I would expect volume to fall after items 1 to 3

My priority would be the first three, since they are copy, screen and data-display changes. Together they address the main trust and expectation issues before any expensive build.

F. References

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